

THE SIMPLE VERSION

ThirdWave

What We're Building, Who's Doing What, and When

A plain-language guide to the first version of ThirdWave · 10 weeks

What this document is

No technical terms. This is the plain-English version of our build plan — what the first version of ThirdWave will actually do, who on our team is building which part, and what happens week by week until it's ready for a real pilot. If you want the full technical detail, that lives in a separate document.

1. What We're Building

ThirdWave is a warning system for floods. It connects three groups of people so that everyone knows what's happening and what to do about it, fast:

- Government officers, who watch for flood risk and send out warnings.
- Citizens, who get warned in time, and can report flooding they see.
- Emergency responders, who get sent to help when something happens.

Here's the whole idea in one line:

We spot the danger early → we warn people in time → people report what they see → help gets sent → the problem gets fixed.

Right now, that chain of events is slow, or doesn't happen at all. ThirdWave's whole job is to make every link in that chain faster and more reliable.

2. Why We're Starting Small First

We could try to build the entire national system all at once. We're not going to — that would take too long, cost too much, and we wouldn't know if it actually works until the very end.

Instead, we're building a smaller, complete version first — a First Version — that does the whole job above, start to finish, but for:

- One kind of emergency: flooding (the most common and dangerous hazard right now).
- One area: a single pilot district, not the whole country yet.

Why this is the smart way to do it

This way, in about 10 weeks, we'll have a real, working system that a real government office, real responders and real citizens can actually use — not a demo, the real thing, just for one area first. We test it, fix what doesn't work, and then grow it to more areas and more types of emergencies afterward. Nothing we build now gets thrown away later — we're just starting with the most important piece.

3. What the First Version Will Actually Do

Here's exactly what each person will be able to do, in plain terms.

For the government office

- Log in to a secure website.
- See a map showing which parts of the district are at risk of flooding right now, and how serious it is (Low, Watch, Warning, or Critical).
- Write and send a flood warning to everyone in the affected area.
- Receive flood reports from citizens, check if they're real, and turn confirmed ones into an official incident.
- Send a responder to deal with a confirmed incident, and track it until it's resolved.
- See a simple list of shelters, with how full they are.

For citizens

- Open the app and immediately see, in plain words, whether their area is safe or at risk.
- Get a warning as a phone notification or text message — even without a smartphone or internet, a text message will still reach them.
- Take a photo of flooding and send a report in a few taps, with their location attached automatically.
- Find the nearest shelter and get directions to it.

For emergency responders

- See a list of jobs they've been assigned to.
- Get directions straight to the location.
- Update their status with one tap: On My Way → Arrived → Job Done.
- Take a photo at the scene, even if there's no signal — it will send automatically once they're back in range.

4. What We're Not Building Yet — On Purpose

These are good ideas, and they're already planned. We're just not building them in the first 10 weeks, so we can focus on getting the core system right and tested.

- Other emergencies besides flooding (heatwaves, landslides, wildfires, etc.) — added once the flood version is proven.
- Covering the whole country — we start with one district, then expand.
- Text-message-only "dial a number" access for basic phones — this needs a separate agreement with phone networks, which we'll start arranging in parallel.
- Detailed statistics and charts for government — for now they'll see simple, live numbers; deeper analysis comes after we have real data to analyse.
- A more advanced, self-learning prediction system — we're starting with a clear, explainable set of rules ("if rainfall is this high AND the river is this high, it's a Warning") so everyone can trust and understand it from day one. We'll upgrade to a smarter model once we've collected a season of real results.

None of this is cut for good — it's simply coming after the first version is live and working.

5. Our Team — Who's Doing What

Three people, three clear jobs. Each person owns their part completely, so there's no confusion about who's responsible for what.

Person 1 — Builds everything you see and tap

In plain terms

This person designs and builds every screen — the government website, the citizen app, and the responder app. If you can see it or tap it, they built it. They make sure it looks professional, works on slow phones and small screens, and is easy for anyone to use, including people with disabilities.

Person 2 — Builds the engine room

In plain terms

This person builds everything happening behind the scenes: where information is safely stored, who's allowed to log in and see what, how a warning actually gets sent out, and how a citizen's report turns into an official job for a responder. If Person 1 builds the dashboard of the car, Person 2 builds the engine underneath it.

Person 3 — Builds the smart part that spots the danger

In plain terms

This person takes in real rainfall and river-level information and turns it into a clear risk level for each area — Low, Watch, Warning, or Critical. They make sure the system always explains why it thinks an area is at risk, in plain language, and that it never quietly shows old information as if it were current.

These three people work closely together every step of the way — the screens Person 1 builds only come alive once they're connected to the engine Person 2 builds and the risk information Person 3 produces. Nobody works in isolation.

6. Our Timeline — Week by Week

Ten weeks from start to a real, working pilot. Here's what will be true, and what you'll be able to see, at the end of each stage.

When	Focus	What we'll show you
Stage 1 • Weeks 1–2	Getting Ready	We set up all our tools and agree exactly how everything should look and work. Nothing to demo yet — this is the foundation everything else is built on.
Stage 2 • Weeks 3–4	Seeing the Risk	You'll be able to see a live map of the pilot district showing current flood risk, based on real rainfall and river information.
Stage 3 • Weeks 5–6	Sending Warnings	A government officer can write a flood warning and send it. Citizens will receive it as a phone notification or a text message.
Stage 4 • Weeks 7–8	Reports & Response	A citizen can report flooding with a photo. An officer can confirm it's real and send a responder, who can accept the job, head to the scene, and mark it resolved.
Stage 5 • Week 9	Testing & Polishing	We test everything thoroughly — fixing problems, making sure it works well on slow connections, and checking it's easy to use for everyone, including people with disabilities.
Stage 6 • Week 10	Real Pilot Launch	We go live for real, in the actual pilot district, with real government officers, real responders, and real citizens using it.

At the end of every stage, we'll show our progress live — not slides, the actual working system — so everyone can see real progress every two weeks, not just at the very end.

7. How We'll Know It's Working

We're not just going to say it's done — we're going to prove it, live, with a real example. Success looks like this:

- A government officer can create a real flood warning and send it out.
- A citizen actually receives that warning on their phone — in under 2 minutes for the app, and under 5 minutes for text message.
- A citizen can report flooding they see, with a photo, in under a minute.
- That report gets checked by an officer, turned into an official job, and a responder is sent.
- The responder marks the job resolved — and everyone, from the officer to the citizen, can see it's been dealt with.

The one test that matters most

Before we call this finished, we will run through the entire chain live, start to finish, at least once: a flood risk is spotted → a warning goes out → a citizen gets it → a citizen reports flooding → it gets confirmed → a responder is sent → the job is marked done. If that whole chain works smoothly, the first version has done its job.

8. What Happens After the First 10 Weeks

Once the pilot is live and working well in one district, we grow it in clear, deliberate steps:

- Add more districts, one at a time, using everything we learned from the pilot.
- Add more types of emergencies beyond flooding, like extreme heat or landslides.
- Add the text-message "dial a number" option for people with basic phones.
- Add deeper statistics and reports for government, once we have real data to work with.
- Upgrade the risk system to a smarter, self-improving model, once it's had a full season to learn from real events.

That's the plan — clear, small, and built to grow.